



**MEETING MINUTES
LANCASTER COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS
TUESDAY, MAY 19, 2026, AT 9:00 AM
COUNTY-CITY BUILDING, ROOM 112**

**COMMISSIONERS: Christa Yoakum, Chair; Chelsea Johnson, Vice Chair;
Sean Flowerday, Matt Schulte, and Rick Vest**

Advance public notice of the meeting was posted on the County-City Building bulletin board, posted to the Lancaster County, Nebraska website, emailed to the media, and published in the Lincoln Journal Star print and digital editions on May 15, 2026.

Commissioners present: Christa Yoakum, Chair
Chelsea Johnson, Vice Chair
Sean Flowerday
Matt Schulte
Rick Vest

Others present: Kristy Bauer, Deputy Chief Administrative Officer
Morgan Sanchez, Deputy County Attorney
Matt Hansen, County Clerk
Leila Luft, County Clerk's Office

Yoakum called the meeting to order at 09:00 a.m. and led the Pledge of Allegiance. The Clerk announced the location of the Nebraska Open Meetings Act.

1. MINUTES – Approval of the minutes of the Board of Commissioners meeting held on May 12, 2026.

MOTION: Flowerday moved and Vest seconded approval of the minutes. Flowerday, Schulte, Vest, Johnson, and Yoakum voted yes. Motion carried 5-0.

2. CLAIMS

A. Approval of the claims processed through May 15, 2026.

MOTION: Johnson moved and Schulte seconded approval of the claims. Schulte, Vest, Johnson, Flowerday, and Yoakum voted yes. Motion carried 5-0.

B. Approval of a claim to the Mediation Center in the amount of \$9,000 (Batch 334590, Document 928765).

MOTION: Flowerday moved and Johnson seconded approval of the claim. Johnson, Flowerday, Schulte, and Yoakum voted yes. Vest abstained. Motion carried 4-0 with one abstention.

3. **CONSENT ITEMS** – These are routine business items that are expected to be adopted without dissent. Any individual item may be removed for special discussion and consideration by a Commissioner or by any member of the public without prior notice. Unless there is an exception, these items will be approved as one with a single vote of the Board of Commissioners. These items are approval of:

A. Amendments to the following County contracts:

1. C-26-0209 with Shawnee Mission Tree Service for right-of-way pruning of trees. (RFQ 25-126. The amendment renews the contract from June 13, 2026, to June 12, 2027. The cost is not to exceed \$15,000.)
2. C-23-0506 with Safety Kleen Systems for recycling solvent and parts washer services. (Quote 6582. The amendment renews the contract from June 13, 2026, to June 12, 2027. The cost is not to exceed \$5,000.)

B. Right-of-way contracts with the following:

1. Joyce Halling Living Trust, 112th Street and Davey Road, in the amount of \$703. (Project 27-23/ A-004)
2. Layne Byron and Jeanette Lynn Rolofson, The Rolofson Family Living Trust, Northwest 40th Street and West Agnew Road, in the amount of \$2,030. (Project 25-24/C-153)

C. Setting a public hearing on Tuesday, June 2, 2026, at 9:00 a.m. in Room 112 of the County-City Building (555 S. 10th Street, Lincoln) regarding adoption of the Lancaster County electrical and mechanical fee schedules.

MOTION: Vest moved and Flowerday seconded approval of the consent items. Johnson, Flowerday, Schulte, Vest, and Yoakum voted yes. Motion carried 5-0.

4. **NEW BUSINESS**

- A. Professional services agreement with HDR Architecture Inc to conduct the medical and behavioral health needs assessment for the Lancaster County Adult Detention Facility. The cost is not to exceed \$360,000. (The term of the agreement is 12 months after the date of execution by both parties.)

Brad Johnson, Corrections Director, explained that the jail population has grown in recent years and that the medical and mental health areas in the facility have not kept pace with the needs of individuals requiring specialized care. Because current spaces are inadequate, staff often must use areas not designed for vulnerable populations, which increases stress for both staff and inmates. HDR has been asked to assess the facility and offer solutions to improve capacity and create more therapeutic environments. Board members noted that the issues have been long-standing and that the assessment aligns with the board's strategic goals.

MOTION: Vest moved and Flowerday seconded approval of Item 4A.

Schulte asked what type of recommendations the assessment might produce and whether changes would involve procedures, remodeling, or adding capacity. B. Johnson said all options are possible because the current infrastructure does not meet best practices, and some level of renovation or repurposing is likely. He emphasized that the review will look at all housing areas, not just mental health, and that increasing mental health and infirmary capacity could reduce pressure on general housing. Schulte confirmed the scope is broad and includes operational and facility considerations. B. Johnson noted the study will likely take the full 12 months due to its complexity. Board members agreed that the assessment is needed, citing current overcrowding, out-of-county placements, and concerns about providing appropriate care. They expressed support for improving therapeutic environments and praised staff efforts while acknowledging the need for better resources.

ROLL CALL: Flowerday, Schulte, Vest, Johnson, and Yoakum voted yes. Motion carried 5-0.

The Clerk returned to Item 2A with an amendment for payroll (Exhibit 1).

MOTION: Vest moved and Flowerday seconded to make an amendment to include the payroll claims in Item 2A. Schulte, Vest, Johnson, Flowerday, and Yoakum voted yes. Motion carried 5-0.

MOTION: Flowerday moved and Vest seconded approval of Item 2A with the payroll claims amendment. Vest, Johnson, Flowerday, Schulte, and Yoakum voted yes. Motion carried 5-0.

The Clerk returned to Item 4B.

- B.** Recommendation from the Purchasing Agent on behalf of the County Sheriff to award and execute a purchase order to purchase a mobile license plate reader system (LPR) and software licenses in the amount of \$19,259.14. (Full contract expenditure after five years is not to exceed \$96,295.70. NASPO Master Agreement OK-MA-145-21-500 to Motorola Solutions. The term of the contract is a five-year term from May 31, 2026, to May 30, 2031.)

Sheriff Terry Wagner explained that the item is an annual renewal for the county's license plate reader program, funded through forfeited assets rather than the general budget. Vest asked for a review of the safeguards due to privacy concerns. Wagner noted that state statute, drafted with ACLU involvement, strictly governs use. The system only alerts law enforcement when a plate previously entered as stolen or wanted passes a reader, and it does not provide owner or registration data. Data is retained for about 60 days, and misuse carries criminal penalties for law enforcement personnel. Wagner added that similar technology is widely used by private businesses for operational efficiency, and the sheriff's office uses it in a comparable, controlled manner.

MOTION: Vest moved and Flowerday seconded approval of Item 4B.

Yoakum confirmed that the item includes adding a new license plate reader, and Wagner explained that they continue to expand coverage with the goal of creating a full ring of readers around Lancaster County's major highways to help identify vehicles involved in criminal activity.

ROLL CALL: Johnson, Flowerday, Schulte, Vest, and Yoakum voted yes. Motion carried 5-0.

- C.** Interlocal agreement with the City of Lincoln to construct turn lanes on Northwest 56th Street from Holdrege Street to Interstate 80. (The City is responsible for the total design and construction costs estimated to be \$124,638.87, using federal STBG funds and other City funds. NDOT Project LCLC-5287(1); CN13494.)

Assistant County Engineer Larry Legg explained that the agreement adds turn lanes at West Vine Street and Northwest 56th as part of a federally funded project scheduled for letting in October and construction next summer, with the City of Lincoln covering the added cost.

MOTION: Flowerday moved and Johnson seconded approval of Item 4C. Flowerday, Schulte, Vest, Johnson, and Yoakum voted yes. Motion carried 5-0.

- D.** Lancaster County Statement of Values for purposes of Lancaster County insurance policies.

MOTION: Flowerday moved and Johnson seconded approval of Item 4D. Schulte, Vest, Johnson, Flowerday, and Yoakum voted yes. Motion carried 5-0.

5. EXECUTIVE SESSION – (Strategy session regarding a real estate transaction; and legal advice)

The Clerk noted he was notified no executive session was needed.

6. PUBLIC COMMENT – Members of the public wishing to speak on items relating to County business not on the agenda may do so at this time. Each speaker is limited to one appearance of up to five minutes, and

that time may not be reserved, transferred, or otherwise assigned to other speakers. These time limits may be extended or reasonably decreased at the discretion of the Chair.

No one appeared for public comment.

7. **ANNOUNCEMENTS**

- A. The Board of Commissioners will hold a staff meeting, including budget hearings, on Thursday, May 21, 2026, at 8:30 a.m. in Room 112 of the County-City Building (555 South 10th Street, Lincoln).
- B. The Board of Commissioners will hold its regular meeting on Tuesday, May 26, 2026, at 9:00 a.m., with the Board of Equalization immediately following in Room 112 of the County-City Building (555 South 10th Street, Lincoln).
- C. County Commissioners can be reached at 402-441-7447 or commish@lancaster.ne.gov.
- D. The Board of Commissioners meetings are streamed live on YouTube and Facebook (youtube.com/@lancastercountynebraska/streams and [Facebook.com/lancasterne](https://facebook.com/lancasterne)). LNKTV apps are also available on Roku, Apple TV, and Amazon Fire TV.

8. **ADJOURNMENT**

MOTION: Flowerday moved and Johnson seconded to adjourn at 9:22 a.m. Vest, Johnson, Flowerday, Schulte, and Yoakum voted yes. Motion carried 5-0.



Matt Hansen
Lancaster County Clerk



LANCASTER COUNTY PAYROLL DISBURSEMENTS
For the Pay Period April 30, 2026 thru May 13, 2026
Pay Date: May 21, 2026

Exhibit 1

Gross Pay	\$ 3,064,945.55
Employer FICA	\$ 224,082.67
Pension Contribution	\$ 212,581.37
PEHP Contribution	\$ 13,725.00
PEHP Payout	\$ 220.49
Workers Compensation	\$ 2,543.94
Group Insurance	\$ 587,233.36
Employee Reimbursements	\$ 3,275.39
Employee Assistance Program	\$ 1,406.38

LANCASTER COUNTY EMPLOYEE EXPENSE REIMBURSEMENT

For the Pay Period 04/30-05/13/2026

Pay Date: 05/21/2026

ATTACHMENT 1

Employee Name	Department	Reimbursement Description	Amount
Condon, Patrick	Co Attorney	05/06-05/07/2026 Meals	\$68.00
Condon, Patrick	Co Attorney	05/06-05/07/2026 Mileage	\$187.06
Cooper, Jason	Co Attorney	05/05-05/08/2026 Meals	\$173.00
Cooper, Jason	Co Attorney	05/05-05/08/2026 Mileage	\$191.40
Goodro, Amy	Co Attorney	05/06-05/07/2026 Meals	\$89.00
Goodro, Amy	Co Attorney	05/06-05/07/2026 Mileage	\$195.76
Lavene, Jeremy	Co Attorney	05/05-05/08/2026 Meals	\$173.00
Lavene, Jeremy	Co Attorney	05/05-05/08/2026 Mileage	\$191.41
Schmidt, John	Co Attorney	05/05-05/08/2026 Meals	\$204.00
Schmidt, John	Co Attorney	05/05-05/08/2026 Mileage	\$192.86
Zieg, Daniel	Co Attorney	05/05-05/08/2026 Meals	\$204.00
Zieg, Daniel	Co Attorney	05/05-05/08/2026 Mileage	\$187.06
Thorpe, Greg	Co Clerk	05/07/2026 Mileage	\$61.35
Larsen, Robert	Co Engineer	05/12/2026 CDL Renewal	\$64.00
Larsen, Robert	Co Engineer	04/07-04/08/2026 Meals	\$52.00
Legg, Larry	Co Engineer	04/12-04/16/2026 Meals	\$116.00
Goracke, Bill	Co Corrections	03/09-03/12/2026 Meals	\$84.00
Boden, Ronald	Co Sheriff	05/06/2026 Meal	\$21.00
Brady, John	Co Sheriff	04/12-04/15/2026 Meals	\$258.00
Bryant, Chad	Co Sheriff	05/06/2026 Meal	\$21.00
Cherovsky, Kurt	Co Sheriff	04/29/2026 Meal	\$21.00
Guthard, Dennis	Co Sheriff	04/29/2026 & 05/07/2026 Meal	\$42.00
Shandera, Amy	Co Sheriff	05/08/2026 Duplicate Title	\$14.00
Jorgensen, John	Public Defender	04/01-04/22/2026 Mileage	\$15.41
Lopez, Ariana	Public Defender	04/04-04/29/2026 Mileage	\$7.30
Mathews, Emily	Public Defender	03/01-04/30/2026 Mileage	\$102.51
Meinders, Rebecca	Public Defender	04/03-05/05/2026 Mileage	\$41.16
Von Loh, Darik	Public Defender	04/01-04/30/2026 Mileage	\$45.80
Bartels, Roy	Election Commiss	05/12/2026 Primary Election Mileage	\$26.10
Cecava, Greg	Election Commiss	05/12/2026 Primary Election Mileage	\$30.45
Garlock, Judy	Election Commiss	05/12/2026 Primary Election Mileage	\$23.20
Griffin, Alan	Election Commiss	05/12/2026 Primary Election Mileage	\$68.88
Haddow, Earl	Election Commiss	05/12/2026 Primary Election Mileage	\$21.75
Haddow, Patricia	Election Commiss	05/12/2026 Primary Election Mileage	\$26.83
Jacox, Jay	Election Commiss	05/12/2026 Primary Election Mileage	\$21.75
Schmidt, Claudette	Election Commiss	05/12/2026 Primary Election Mileage	\$33.35
			<u>\$3,275.39</u>